

The Game Changers **INDIVIDUALS**

SHANTHA SINHA 58

CHAIRPERSON, National Commission for Protection of Child Rights

BRIDGING THE GULF

I want to ensure that every child gets an education and stands for his/her rights in school," says Shantha Sinha, who, astounded by the lack of agencies specialising in protecting children's rights, founded the M.Venkatarangaiya Foundation in 1981. The foundation, which has rescued 1,00,000 children from work in 500 villages across Andhra Pradesh, runs a bridge course for such children in the nine to 14 age group, to enable them to catch up with regular school children. In recognition of her efforts, she was awarded the Magsaysay Award in 2003, and appointed the first chairperson of the National Commission for Protection of Child



Rights, giving her ample opportunity to diversify her field of operation, from Chattisgarh to Rajasthan. Be it corporal punishment in schools or contesting the notion that only poverty can lead to child labour, she works towards just one mission—returning the most valuable thing to children, their childhood.

by Gunjeet Sra

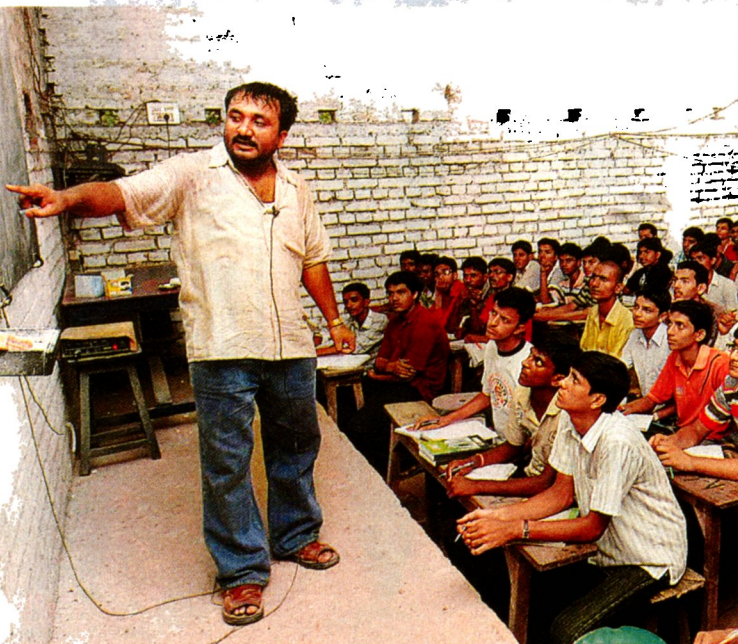
Education Masters in Political Science from Osmania University, Hyderabad, and a Ph.D from JNU.

Usually to be found Working with children through the M.V. Foundation or championing their cause from her Janpath office.

"She has a rare ability to combine academic excellence with social activism in an integral way." Sucheta Mahajan, Professor, Jawaharlal Nehru University

ANAND KUMAR 37 **FOUNDER**, Ramanujan School of Mathematics

STAND UP AND BE COUNTED



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

Mantra for change "I want my students to squeeze, wrench and scrape everything from me. I want them to grasp the knowledge to crack the IIT."

Success technique Sample tests that are conducted every day to make students "immune to all kinds of question shocks."

Success rate In 2008 and 2009, everyone from the Super 30 cracked the IIT-JEE.

One hundred and eighty two of his students have got through the IIT exams in the past seven years, a stupendous achievement when only 2 per cent of those who apply finally qualify. Using a mix of inspirational stories and exam busting techniques, Anand Kumar's Ramanujan School of Mathematics in Patna has become an island of excellence in a sea of teaching shops. From 5,000-6,000 students who appear for the test, Kumar selects 30 for a free-of-cost "Super 30 Programme" which also provides children free accommodation for eight months to help them crack the prestigious joint entrance examination. And to think there was a time when he would deliver home-made papads to households in Patna. And that he had to give up a seat at the University of Cambridge when his father, a postal department employee, died in 1994.

by Amitabh Srivastava

"A good teacher knows what to teach and how to teach. Anand is the best in both spheres."

D.P. Verma, former head of mathematics, Patna Science College